

Ananye Agarwal

Curriculum Vitae

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Current Position

Aug'23- **Skild AI**, Bay Area

Present *Founding Research Scientist*

○ One of the first employees at Skild AI, helped scale it to a \$14B valuation

○ Researched robot foundation models, focusing on large-scale RL and world models

Education

2021-2026 **Carnegie Mellon University**

Ph.D. in Machine Learning

Thesis: *Generalist Robot Control via In-Context Learning*

Advisor: Deepak Pathak

Defended February 2026

2017-2021 **Indian Institute of Technology, Delhi**

B.Tech. in Computer Science and Engineering

Major GPA: 10 / 10 (ranked 1st in class) Cumulative GPA: 9.978 / 10

President's gold medalist (valedictorian)

Honors and Awards

2017 **Gold Medal** at the International Physics Olympiad (IPhO)

2021 **President's Gold Medal** at IIT Delhi (valedictorian equivalent)

2017 **Ranked 3rd** in JEE-Advanced (of 180K) and JEE-Main (of 1.2M candidates)

2025 **MIT Technology Review Innovators Under 35** (Asia Pacific)

2025 **Best Paper Finalist** at Conference on Robot Learning '25 (LocoFormer)

2024 **Oral presentation** at ICML '24 (SAPG)

2022 **Best Systems Paper Award** at Conference on Robot Learning '22

2022 **Best Paper Award** at CVPR '22 Multimodal Learning Workshop

Publications

[12] **LocoFormer: Generalist Locomotion via Long-context Adaptation**

Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL) 2025

Best Paper Finalist

Min Liu, Deepak Pathak, *Ananye Agarwal*

[11] **Legolas: Deep Leg-Inertial Odometry**

Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL) 2024

Justin Wasserman, *Ananye Agarwal*, Rishabh Jangir, Girish Chowdhary, Deepak Pathak, Abhinav Gupta

[10] **SAPG: Split and Aggregate Policy Gradients**

International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML) 2024

Oral

Jayesh Singla*, *Ananye Agarwal**, Deepak Pathak

- [9] **Demonstrating Learning from Humans on Open-Source Dexterous Robot Hands**
Robotics: Science and Systems (RSS) 2024
 Kenneth Shaw, **Ananye Agarwal**, Shikhar Bahl, Mohan Kumar Srirama, Alexandre Kirchmeyer, Aditya Kannan, Aravind Sivakumar, Deepak Pathak
- [8] **SPIN: Simultaneous Perception, Interaction and Navigation**
Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR) 2024
 Shagun Uppal, **Ananye Agarwal**, Haoyu Xiong, Kenneth Shaw, Deepak Pathak
- [7] **Extreme Parkour with Legged Robots**
International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA) 2024
 Xuxin Cheng*, Kexin Shi*, **Ananye Agarwal**, Deepak Pathak
- [6] **Dexterous Functional Grasping**
Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL) 2023
Ananye Agarwal, Shagun Uppal, Kenneth Shaw, Deepak Pathak
- [5] **LEAP Hand: Low-Cost, Efficient, and Anthropomorphic Hand for Robot Learning**
Robotics: Science and Systems (RSS) 2023
 Kenneth Shaw, **Ananye Agarwal**, Deepak Pathak
- [4] **Legged Locomotion in Challenging Terrains using Egocentric Vision**
Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL) 2022
Best Systems Paper Award
Ananye Agarwal*, Ashish Kumar*, Jitendra Malik[†], Deepak Pathak[†]
- [3] **Coupling Vision and Proprioception for Navigation of Legged Robots**
Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR) 2022
Best Paper Award at Multimodal Learning Workshop
 Zipeng Fu*, Ashish Kumar*, **Ananye Agarwal**, Haozhi Qi, Jitendra Malik, Deepak Pathak
- [2] **SiameseXML: Siamese Networks meet Extreme Classifiers with 100M Labels**
International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML) 2021
 Kunal Dahiya, **Ananye Agarwal**, Deepak Saini, Gururaj K, Jian Jiao, Amit Singh, Sumeet Agarwal, Purushottam Kar, Manik Varma
- [1] **End-to-End Neuro-Symbolic Architecture for Image-to-Image Reasoning Tasks**
arXiv preprint arXiv:2106.03121, 2021
Ananye Agarwal, Pradeep Shenoy, Mausam

Media Coverage

LocoFormer: Generalist Locomotion via Long-context Adaptation

- [This AI-Powered Robot Keeps Going Even if You Attack It With a Chainsaw \(WIRED\)](#)
- [New AI Can Control a Robot Even If Its Legs Get Chainsawed Off \(Futurism\)](#)
- [It can still crawl even after having its four legs sawed off \(36Kr\)](#)

Extreme Parkour with Legged Robots

- [Video Friday \(IEEE Spectrum\)](#)
- [Small Robotic Dog Takes Giant Parkour Leaps \(CMU\)](#)
- [Robot dogs can already do this. \(Weixin\)](#)
- [CMU robot dog goes downstairs upside down! Released and open-source immediately. \(Weixin\)](#)
- [Extreme Parkour with Legged Robots \(Hacker News\)](#)

Legged Locomotion in Challenging Terrains using Egocentric Vision

- Watch this robot dog scramble over tricky terrain just by using its camera ([MIT Tech Review](#))
- This robotic dog can walk over just about any terrain ([TechCrunch](#))
- Video Friday: Little Robot, Big Stairs ([IEEE Spectrum](#))
- CMU Researchers Develop Low-Cost Robot Dog That Can Climb Stairs and Rocks ([TechEBlog](#))
- Taking a look at a new advancement in AI ([CBS Pittsburgh Live TV](#))
- Low-Cost Robot Navigates Nearly Any Obstacle ([Unite.AI](#))
- Budget robots inspired by animals a step forward for humans ([Technology](#))
- Researchers build a four-legged robot that can climb stairs, hills ([Techcircle](#))
- honeybee life spans, little robots, near-sightedness genes, and ear pod hearing aids ([Cosmos](#))

Previous Experience

- May'20- **Microsoft Research, Bangalore, India**
Nov'20 *Research Intern, with Manik Varma*
Extreme classification; led to SiameseXML (ICML 2021)
- Jun'20- **Uber Research**
Jul'20 *Research Intern*
Contributed to PiranhaJS, part of Uber's open-source [Piranha](#) project
- May'20- **Samsung Research, Seoul, Korea**
Jun'20 *Research Intern*
Linux kernel network stack
- May'19- **Microsoft Research, Bangalore, India**
Aug'19 *Research Intern, with Ankit Garg*
Algebraic complexity theory

Service

- 2023-2024 **Reviewer**
NeurIPS 2024, CoRL 2024, NeurIPS 2023, ICCV 2023, CVPR 2023
- 2024 **CMU MLD PhD admissions committee**
Member
- 2023 **CMU MLD MS admissions committee**
Member
- 2022 **CoRL Workshop Organizer**
Sim-to-Real Robot Learning: Locomotion and Beyond

Invited Talks

- Jul 2026 **Panelist at Humanity & AGI Summit 2026, Stanford Faculty Club**
Panel: Embodied AI Enters the Real World
- Oct 2024 **Guest Talk at Prof. Pieter Abbeel's lab**
Scaling RL and simulation for general-purpose robot skills
- Jun 2024 **ELLIS Workshop on 3D Computer Vision and Robotics**
Legged locomotion and extreme parkour using egocentric vision
- Jan 2024 **Guest Lecture at UMich EECS 598-010: Action and Perception**
Building robots that adapt
- Jan 2024 **Guest Lecture at UC Irvine MAE195: Introduction to Robot Motion Planning & Navigation**
General-purpose robotics using large-scale simulation